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INSTALLING LINUX

Linux Installation

Installation Choices

A successful system administrator will be able to install Linux on either a bare metal machine, or a virtual machine. The installation process is basically the same for both virtual and physical machines. The differences and virtual environment configuration are not covered in detail in this course.

There are a variety of ways to install Linux for this course, if you do not already have a working installation. You can install directly on your computer, which will give you the best performance and most satisfying experience. If you already have an operating system installed (such as Microsoft Windows or MacOS), you may keep that in place while you configure a "dual boot" system. This can, however, be tricky, and it takes some experience to avoid profoundly messing up your system.

Thus, for most students who need to do a fresh install, the use of a freely available hypervisor, such as VMware Workstation Player or Oracle VirtualBox is the method of choice and is rather easy to implement. The hypervisor runs on the host operating system, and Linux is installed as a guest virtual machine (VM).

Whether you do a physical or virtual machine installation, only the beginning of the procedure is different; once the initial setup is complete, the experience is the same. We will show in some detail the use of VMware Workstation Player in order to be concrete. It is easy enough to replicate the equivalent steps with Oracle VirtualBox.